FRANMARINE UNDERWATER SERVICES PTY LTD

DIVING AND ROV OPERATIONS

Procedure

MV SEAGULL | UVI: 425689

Marine Order 504 (2024) — Schedule 1 Compliance

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Review Frequency

This document shall be reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner following a significant incident, change of operations, vessel modification, or change in applicable legislation.

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes the requirements for diving and ROV (remotely operated vehicle) operations conducted from MV Seagull. All diving operations shall comply with AS/NZS 2299.1:2015 Occupational Diving Operations and the WHS Regulation 2017 (NSW) Chapter 4 Part 4.7.

1.1 Regulatory Reference

AS/NZS 2299.1:2015 Occupational Diving Operations. WHS Regulation 2017 (NSW), Chapter 4, Part 4.7. Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5).

2. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS — DIVING

- All diving shall be conducted under a site-specific Dive Plan approved by the Diving Supervisor.
- All diving operations shall comply with AS/NZS 2299.1:2015 in full.
- The minimum dive team comprises: Diving Supervisor, Diver, and Standby Diver.
- All divers shall hold current ADAS qualifications appropriate to the dive method and depth.
- MV Seagull shall display the Alpha flag and, when restricted in ability to manoeuvre, the appropriate lights/shapes per COLREGs Rule 27.
- The vessel master shall radio the appropriate port authority before diving commences, advising of the vessel's position, nature of operations, and requesting other vessels to keep clear. A sécurité call shall also be broadcast on VHF Ch 16.

3. PRE-DIVE CHECKS

- Dive plan reviewed and briefed to all team members.
- Diving equipment inspected and functional (BCD, regulators, cylinders, gauges, lights, knives).
- Emergency equipment staged: oxygen administration kit, Scale G first aid kit, emergency contact list.
- Decompression tables or dive computer set to correct altitude and gas mix.
- Diving ladder or platform rigged (refer FUS-SMS-SGL-05D).
- Vessel propulsion state for the dive established per §4.1 — by default the engine shut down and the propeller isolated and tagged out; where the vessel must remain able to manoeuvre, live boating controls (§4.1) apply under a documented risk assessment.
- Weather and tidal conditions assessed and acceptable.

4. DURING DIVE OPERATIONS

- Maintain continuous communication between Diving Supervisor and diver (line signals, through-water comms, or hard-wire as appropriate) in accordance with AS/NZS 2299.1:2015.
- Monitor diver's bubbles and position from the surface.
- Standby diver shall be dressed and ready to enter the water within 1 minute.
- Record dive profiles, bottom times, and decompression status.
- Vessel master shall monitor VHF Ch 16 and the appropriate port authority channel, and maintain a lookout for approaching vessels.
- No vessel shall approach within 100 metres of a vessel displaying the Alpha flag (or as restricted by Harbour Master Directions).

4.1 Vessel Propulsion State and Live Boating

Vessel control while a diver is in the water follows a defined hierarchy, applied from the most effective to the least effective for diver safety. The default is to shut down the engine entirely. Any state in which the engine remain running with a diver in the water is permitted only under a documented live-boating risk assessment, applying the controls in this section.

- Engines shut down (most effective; the default state): the engine shut down and the propeller isolated and tagged out. Used whenever the vessel does not need to manoeuvre with a diver in the water.
- Engines running, gear in neutral: used where the vessel must be held ready to manoeuvre. The engine remain in neutral with no drive to the propeller; positive confirmation from the Diving Supervisor is required before any gear is engaged.
- Live boating (engines engaged with a diver deployed; least preferred): used only where the vessel must actively manoeuvre during the dive, and only under a documented live-boating risk assessment with the controls below.

Where the vessel operates in any state other than engines shut down with a diver in the water (options 2 and 3 above), the following controls apply:

- A documented live-boating risk assessment is completed and briefed to the dive team before diving commences.
- A dedicated tender is assigned to each diver and continuously manages that diver's umbilical, keeping it clear of the propeller.
- Continuous communication is maintained between the Diving Supervisor, the diver, and the Master at all times.
- The Master manoeuvres only on the Diving Supervisor's direction and keeps the propeller clear of the diver and umbilical; the diver is kept clear of the area beneath and abaft the vessel near the running gear.
- A clear abort condition is briefed before diving. On abort, the engine is returned to neutral or shut down and the diver is recovered or made safe.

Job-specific live-boating controls — the current, vessel positioning, traffic, and tender arrangements for the particular task — are detailed in the daily Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS) for the job. This procedure sets the standing method; the SWMS applies it to the site.

5. POST-DIVE

- Confirm all divers are safely back on board and accounted for.
- Debrief the dive team and record any incidents, near misses, or equipment defects.
- Record dive details in the dive log: date, time, depth, bottom time, gas used, decompression status.
- Recover diving signals and Alpha flag.
- Advise the appropriate port authority that diving operations are complete.

6. ROV OPERATIONS

When conducting ROV (remotely operated vehicle) inspections from MV Seagull, the following requirements apply in addition to the general positioning requirements in FUS-SMS-SGL-05C:

6.1 General Requirements

- ROV operations shall follow the Franmarine ROV standard operating procedure.
- Maintain a dedicated ROV operator and a vessel helmsman during ROV deployment.
- MV Seagull shall display the Alpha flag and appropriate restricted-in-ability-to-manoeuvre signals as for diving operations.
- Radio the appropriate port authority before commencing ROV operations.

6.2 Deployment and Recovery

- Deploy the ROV from the designated launch point and maintain a clear tether route.
- Monitor the ROV tether to prevent entanglement with the vessel, the propeller, or structure.
- Ensure electrical cables are managed and do not create trip hazards on deck.
- Recover the ROV before repositioning the vessel.

6.3 Combined Dive and ROV Operations

Where diving and ROV operations are conducted simultaneously or sequentially from the same vessel:

- The Diving Supervisor shall coordinate with the ROV operator to deconflict tether routes and work areas.
- The ROV shall not operate in the diver's work area without positive communication and confirmation from the Diving Supervisor.
- If the ROV tether crosses the diver's route, the ROV shall be recovered or repositioned before the diver enters the water.

7. EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

Diving emergency procedures are detailed in FUS-SMS-SGL-06C. The emergency procedures cover:

- Missing or overdue diver.
- Injured or unconscious diver.
- Decompression illness (DCI).
- Equipment failure at depth.
- Entanglement.

The location of the nearest recompression chamber shall be confirmed before each diving operation. The nearest recompression chamber is Prince of Wales Hospital Hyperbaric Unit (Randwick) (02 9382 3880). DAN emergency hotline: +61 8 8212 9242.

8. RECORDS

Diving and ROV operations are recorded in the dive log, the vessel logbook, and the relevant project documentation.

9. REFERENCES

- AS/NZS 2299.1:2015 Occupational Diving Operations
- WHS Regulation 2017 (NSW), Chapter 4, Part 4.7
- COLREGs Rule 27 (Vessels Restricted in Ability to Manoeuvre)
- Franmarine ROV Standard Operating Procedure
- FUS-SMS-SGL-06C Medical and Diving Emergency Procedure
- FUS-SMS-SGL-05C Mooring and Berthing (operations near structures)
- FUS-SMS-SGL-05D Means of Access
- Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5)